workPulse — MD Demo Runbook

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How to use this

Everything created during the live demo on production is permanent — treat it as real work, because it is. One real task and one real project, both of which stay useful after the room empties.

Rehearse the whole run in UAT first. Demo on production only the two cases below.

The run is about twenty minutes: roughly eight on the task, ten on the project, the rest on questions. Each step names who clicks, what they click, and the one line worth saying while doing it. The spoken lines are prompts, not a script — say them in your own words.

Four people can run this. Five if the Manager is played separately; otherwise the Dept Head covers that part.

Before the demo

Run these the morning of, on production, in this order. The first two have each caused a false bug report in this project already.

#	Check	How	If it fails
1	Both processes restarted after the deploy	Profile, top right — the Version line matches the commit IT deployed	Ask IT to restart API **and** web, not just rebuild
2	Every player can sign in	Each person signs in themselves, on their own machine	Fix before the room fills, never during
3	The assignee can sign in	The person receiving the demo task opens **My tasks**	Pick a different assignee
4	Synapse launcher opens workPulse	Click the tile from Synapse	Use the direct URL and skip the tile in the demo
5	Task types are listed	Start creating a task, open the Type dropdown	Stop — escalate, nothing works without this

Two known gaps, both expected, neither blocking:

- **Open the Serves dropdown on a draft activity and confirm your processes are listed.** The whole desk card section depends on it. If it is empty, production did not get the policies and processes — drop Part 1b and say the control register goes live this week.
- **Check the task type list is complete** — `OPERATIONAL`, `COMPLIANCE`, `CRITICAL_OPS`, `MANAGEMENT`, `PROJECT`, `ROUTINE`.

Have UAT open in a second browser tab. If a production step misbehaves, move to UAT rather than debugging in front of the MD.

The cast

Roles come from Synapse and are read live on every request — a role granted during the demo takes effect on the next click, with no re-login. Useful if someone is missing one.

Plays	Synapse role needed	Does in the demo
Admin	`SYSTEM_ADMIN`	Drives the screen, creates the project, narrates
Dept Head	`DEPARTMENT_HEAD`	Creates the task, adds milestones and the risk
Manager *(optional)*	`MANAGER`	Verifies the task — the maker-checker moment
Executive	`EXECUTIVE`	Receives the task and does the work
MD	`EXECUTIVE` + named Approver	Makes the decision on the project

Two rules that shape who can play what:

- **Nobody can verify their own work.** Not a Manager, not System Admin — there is no override anywhere in the code. So the person who does the task and the person who verifies it must be two different people. This is the single most important thing the demo proves.
- **A task assigned to yourself skips Accept**, because creating it is accepting it. If the Dept Head assigns the task to themselves, the Accept step vanishes and the demo loses a beat. Assign it to the Executive.

The MD only needs `EXECUTIVE` to see the Command Centre. His decision moment works because he is **named as the Approver** on that decision, not because of his role — only the named Approver can decide, whoever else is in the room.

If no Manager plays

The Dept Head verifies. Verification accepts the named reviewer, or anyone holding `MANAGER`, `DEPARTMENT_HEAD` or `SYSTEM_ADMIN` — so the Dept Head qualifies on role alone.

Creating the task does not disqualify them. The only person barred from verifying is the **assignee**. So Dept Head creates → Executive does → Dept Head verifies is proper maker-checker: the maker and the checker are two different people.

Set the **Dept Head as reviewer** when creating the task in that case. It works either way, but naming the reviewer up front is what you want the MD to see — the checker is decided when the work is handed out, not chosen afterwards by whoever is free.

Avoid having the Admin verify. It is permitted, but a system administrator signing off business work is the wrong picture for this audience.

Part 1 — the task

Pick a real one. Something the Accounts head genuinely wants tracked, due in the next week or two, assigned to a real person in his team. Not a test. The moment that lands is opening it in the assignee's own screen and seeing it already sitting there.

Choose task type `OPERATIONAL`. It requires evidence but not verification, which keeps the path short while still showing the evidence gate. If you want the full maker-checker beat, use `COMPLIANCE` or `CRITICAL_OPS` instead — those cannot be closed without a verifier, which is a stronger story for a pre-IPO audience.

Step 1 — Dept Head creates it

1. **Tasks → New task**
2. Title: the real one, in the words the Accounts head would use
3. Type: `OPERATIONAL` · Priority: `MEDIUM` · Due date: a real date
4. Assignee: the **Executive**. Reviewer: the **Manager** — set this now, it cannot be skipped later
5. Add two or three real checklist items
6. Create

> Say: *"I have not sent an email. The work now exists, it has an owner, a date, and a named checker."*

The task gets a reference like `WP-000123`. Read it out — it is quotable in email and the MD will notice that.

Step 2 — Executive accepts and works it

7. Executive opens **My tasks**. The task is there, status `ASSIGNED`
8. **Accept** → `ACCEPTED`
9. **Start** → `IN_PROGRESS`
10. Tick the checklist items
11. Add a comment — use the **dictation** button and speak a sentence in Gujarati or Hindi

> Say: *"He spoke in his own language. The note is saved in English, so whoever picks this up next can read it."*

Dictation is the feature that gets remembered. Do not skip it.

Step 3 — the gate

12. **Send for review** → `PENDING_REVIEW`

If the reviewer was never set, this refuses with *"This task has no reviewer, so there is nobody to send it to."* That is why step 4 above matters.

13. Still as the Executive, try to **Verify** it

It refuses: *"You cannot verify your own work. Verification requires a different person."*

> Say: *"That is segregation of duties, enforced by the system. No manager can override it. No administrator can override it. There is no setting that turns it off."*

This is the most important twenty seconds of the demo. Let the refusal sit on screen.

Step 4 — Manager verifies and closes

14. Manager opens the task → **Verify** → `VERIFIED`
15. **Close** → `CLOSED`

If you chose a type requiring verification, show that Close is refused straight from `COMPLETED`: *"This task type must be Verified before it can be Closed."*

Step 5 — the trail

16. Open the task's **history**

Every transition, who made it, when, with reasons where the system demanded one. Blocking, holding, rejecting and reopening all require a written reason and the field will not let you past without one.

> Say to the MD: *"Nobody typed this up afterwards. It was recorded as it happened."*

Part 1b — the desk card

Now possible, because the policies and processes exist. This is the part that answers *"where does the recurring work come from?"* — and for a pre-IPO audience it is the strongest section in the demo.

Run it **after** the task, not before. The task shows what the tool does; the desk card shows why the work existed in the first place. That order lands better than the reverse.

Step 1 — Dept Head creates the card

1. **Desk cards → New desk card**
2. Code, name, department, and the **holder** — a real person in Accounts

> Say: *"This is not a job description. It is the list of obligations this chair carries — and it stays with the chair when the person changes."*

Step 2 — add the obligation

3. **Add activity** — title, task type `OPERATIONAL`, priority `MEDIUM`, recurrence `Daily`, estimated minutes
4. On the activity row, set **Serves** — pick the process you created

> Say: *"Every obligation has to name the control it serves. If it serves nothing, the system will not approve it."*

To make that concrete, leave Serves on **No control** for a moment and point at the message the card shows: *"set the control it serves, on its row"*. Then set it. The refusal is more convincing than the explanation.

Step 3 — approve

5. **Approve** on the activity row
6. **Approve card** at the top

> Say: *"That card is now live. The daily work it describes will generate itself, to the right person, with the control it answers to attached."*

Optional — the deeper gate

If there is time and appetite, add a second activity with task type `COMPLIANCE` or priority `CRITICAL`, and try to approve it. It refuses: that class of work needs a **written procedure, approved by a second person**, before the obligation itself can be approved.

> Say: *"For critical and compliance work, somebody has to write down how it is done, and somebody else has to agree the steps are right — before the obligation is live at all."*

This is a strong close to the governance story. Rehearse it; do not improvise it.

One thing to be ready for

If the MD or the Accounts head asks **"who approved that card — could the same person create and approve it?"**, the honest answer today is **yes**. Desk card approval has no second-person check; workflows and task verification do.

It is on the list to close. Say so plainly if asked. Do not volunteer it, and do not claim a control that is not there — that is exactly the sort of thing an auditor tests later.

Part 2 — the project

Pick something that runs for months and that both of them already care about — the statutory audit, the IPO diligence workstream, or an Accounts initiative he owns. An Accounts-owned project lands better with the Accounts head than the workPulse rollout does.

The project code is permanent and unique. Use your real convention. Nothing with TEST in it.

Step 1 — Admin creates it

1. **Projects → New project**
2. Code and name: the real ones
3. Owner: the Accounts head · Sponsor: the **MD** · Project manager: whoever actually runs it
4. Start and target dates: real

Step 2 — Dept Head gives it substance

5. Add three or four **milestones** with real target dates
6. Mark any genuinely finished one complete

7. **Raise a risk** — a real one, and mark it blocking if it truly is
8. **Attach the task** from Part 1 if it belongs to this project

An empty project shows GREEN forever, because health is computed from milestones, risks and tasks. A sharp MD will ask why everything is green. One honest amber beats a clean board.

> Say: *"The colour is computed from what is actually in there. Nobody sets it by hand — and if somebody overrides it, the override is recorded with their name and their reason."*

Step 3 — accountability on screen

9. Open **RACI** and assign: Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed

Exactly one person can be Accountable at a time — the system enforces it. Make the Accounts head Accountable while the MD is watching.

> Say: *"One name, not a committee. The system will not let there be two."*

Step 4 — the MD's moment

This is the part to rehearse, because the MD is driving.

10. Admin creates a **decision** on the project — a real open question the MD would actually settle
11. In the DACI assignments, name the **MD as Approver**. Driver: the project manager. Contributors and Informed as appropriate
12. **Hand the MD the keyboard or let him use his own machine**
13. MD opens the decision, types the outcome, and clicks **Decide**

Only the named Approver can do this. If anyone else tries, it refuses.

> Say: *"That decision is now part of the project record, with your name and the date on it. Six months from now, when someone asks why we went that way, the answer is here and not in somebody's inbox."*

For an MD heading into IPO diligence, this is the moment the tool stops being a task tracker and becomes a governance record. Give it room.

Step 5 — the Command Centre

14. MD opens **Command Centre**

The executive view: health across projects, what is at risk, what needs him. Let him click around rather than narrating it — whatever he clicks first tells you what he actually cares about, which is worth more than the rest of the demo.

It will look sparse, because there is one real project in it. Say so plainly rather than apologising for it: *"This fills as departments come on. Today there is one project in here and it is a real one."*

What not to touch

Do not demo	Why	If asked
Recurring generation running	The card was approved minutes ago; nothing has generated yet	*"It generates on its schedule — tomorrow morning for a daily obligation."*
Appraisal evidence and shadow scores	Computed from months of data; it will look empty or wrong	*"That needs a quarter of real usage before it says anything honest."*
MIS and coverage reports	Same reason	Same answer
Masters and admin screens	Nothing to show, and the department master still has duplicates	Do not open it
SLA targets	Not yet set	*"Being agreed with each department head now."*

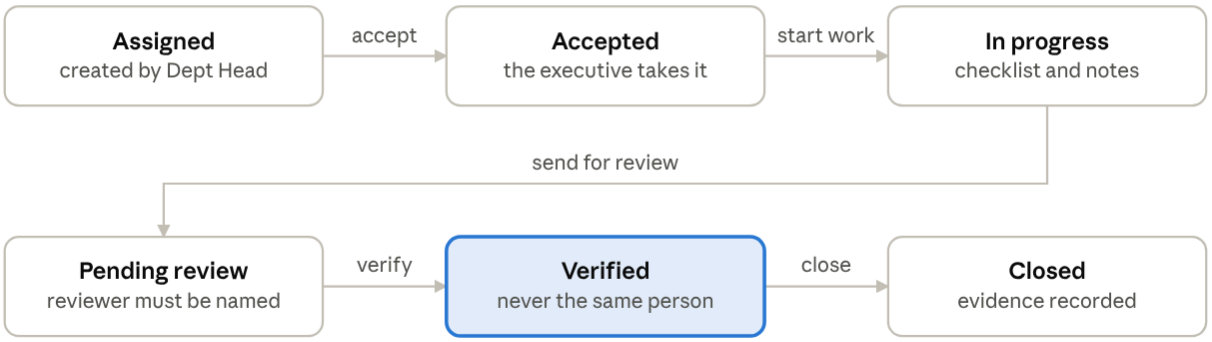
The duplicate departments are the one that could embarrass you if someone opens a dropdown: `Compliance` and `COMPLIANCE`, `Operations` and `OPERATIONS`, `IT` and `Technology`, `Product` and `Product Management` all exist side by side. If it comes up, name it as known and scheduled rather than being surprised by it.

If something breaks, move to UAT and carry on. Do not debug on screen. Nothing in this demo is worth the five minutes of silence that debugging costs you.

Reference for questions

Verification is the one gate with no override

Task lifecycle as the demo walks it



task lifecycle · 6 states, 1 hard gate

Side routes exist and every one demands a written reason: Blocked (which also demands a named owner for the block), On hold, Deferred, Rejected and Reopened. Cancelled is final. The clock pauses on Blocked and On hold, so waiting on somebody else never counts against the assignee.

Who can do what

Action	Who	Hard rule
Create a task	Anyone signed in	—
Accept, work, send for review	The assignee	—
Verify	The named reviewer, or any Manager / Dept Head / Admin	**Never the assignee. No override exists.**
Close	Assignee, reviewer or manager	Types requiring verification must be Verified first
Reassign	Manager and above	Reason required; cannot assign to the reviewer
Cancel	Assignee or manager	Reason required; final
Reopen	Reviewer or manager	Reason required
Create a project	Manager, Dept Head, Project Manager, Admin	—

Action	Who	Hard rule
Milestones, risks, RACI	Manager, Dept Head, Project Manager, Admin	Exactly one Accountable at a time
Decide a decision	**Only the named Approver**	Role does not override it

If asked something not covered

Say you will confirm and follow up rather than guessing. An MD remembers a wrong answer longer than a missing one.

The exact values to type, ready to adapt: Demo content